

Getting started with AI for Work and Study

DGP0959 · Student setup guide · Reviewed 4 October 2026 · Draft for tutor review before VLE distribution

You can take part without buying an AI subscription. Start with a tool you can access; if access fails, use the provided example response or work with a partner. Optional benefits below have their own eligibility conditions.

1. Check your access

Bring a Wi-Fi laptop or tablet. Check that you can open the course VLE area and your UM email. If you have not activated your UM account, follow the [UM account guidance](#) or contact [UM IT Services](#). Tell the tutor if you cannot access the VLE; do not create a second university identity to work around a problem.

Before class, record privately: which tool you can access, whether your account is personal or university-managed, and whether you can start a chat. Keep passwords and verification codes private.

2. Start with Gemini through your UM account

UM IT Services confirms Gemini access for staff and students, including research and custom-assistant features, with usage caps. UM-account interactions are not used to train Google's models or reviewed by humans under UM's agreement. This does not grant permission to upload confidential material. See [UM Google Workspace guidance](#).

1. Open [Gemini](#) in your browser.
2. Sign in using your activated UM account through the institutional sign-in flow.
3. Check the account indicator to ensure you are using your UM identity, rather than a personal Google account.
4. Start a chat and try the fictional exercise below.
5. If access is denied or a feature is missing, note the message and contact IT Services. Use the class fallback meanwhile.

A university email does not automatically confer every paid consumer Google plan. Check what your account actually offers. Individual participant access still needs to be checked in class.

3. Start with ChatGPT

1. Open [ChatGPT](#) in your browser.
2. If you already have an account, sign in using your usual method. If you need an account, follow the site's current account-creation option and complete its verification prompts. Registration screens can vary; ask for help if you are unsure which option to use.
3. Read the terms shown. You do not need to purchase an upgrade for this course's first exercise.
4. Start a new conversation. If Chat and Work choices are shown, choose Chat for this beginner exercise.
5. Type the example below, read the response, and send the revision in the same conversation.
6. Save the useful response in your own notes, alongside the prompt and the changes you made.

The browser conversation steps follow [OpenAI's quickstart](#). The account-creation branch is general navigation guidance; exact sign-up labels and verification screens still need a tutor walkthrough before illustrated instructions are distributed.

4. Try a first task and check it

The following notes are fictional:

I can study Monday 17:00–18:00 and Thursday 17:00–18:00. My short report is due Friday at 12:00. I need time to outline, draft and check it.

Prompt:

Using only these notes, suggest a study plan. Keep all work within the stated study hours. Show a table with day, time and task. Flag anything you cannot fit rather than inventing extra time.

Check: Does it use only the two available hours? Does it finish before the deadline? Does it leave time for checking? Is any date or requirement invented?

Revision:

Reserve the final 15 minutes on Thursday for my own review. Adjust the other tasks and flag whether the remaining time seems insufficient.

Keep the final decision yourself. A well-formatted answer can still contain a scheduling error.

5. Optional parallel learning: AI għal Kulhadd

[AI for All](#) is a free national learning programme for Maltese citizens and residents with an active eID. Successful completion can provide a certificate and a 12-month AI-platform subscription. This is separate from DegreePlus attendance.

1. Follow the official service page to ai4all.gov.mt.
2. Register/sign in with eID; choose a language and complete onboarding.
3. Under My Catalogues, activate the AI Programme Bundle and open it from My Bundles.
4. Follow Access Course, complete the three fundamental modules, then the platform exam.
5. When eligible, choose one provider: ChatGPT Plus or Microsoft 365 Personal with Copilot AI. The selection cannot change after a code is issued.
6. Follow your personal redemption instructions. A ChatGPT code requires no active paid ChatGPT subscription at redemption; it must be redeemed within 12 months of 18 May 2026.
7. Keep the code private. Use the programme's Help & Support if blocked.

See the [programme FAQ](#) and [ChatGPT redemption page](#) for current terms. Do not cancel or purchase a subscription solely on the basis of this guide; check your own eligibility and instructions first.

Recommended pace: start after Session 1 and complete alongside the early workshops, at a pace that suits you. Students without eID or an eligible subscription remain fully included in DGP0959.

6. Use AI in coursework with permission

Check your assignment's instructions and your tutor's permission before using AI for assessed answers. Retain drafts, check sources, and follow the required acknowledgement rules. The [UM student FAQ](#) distinguishes learning support from assessed work.

For our practice, use supplied fictional examples or public material. A practice exercise here is not permission to generate an assessed report in another unit.

Keep a simple learning log: task; tool and displayed model/version if available; prompt; useful output; checks; your edits. This helps you explain how you worked.

Before Session 1

- Bring your device and charger.
- Try one available tool and the example above.
- Note one question and one task you want to improve.
- Tell the tutor privately about access difficulties.

Interface screenshots will be added after a tutor checks the actual accounts and screens. This guide collects no account details and is not a login form.